

BEAR BATS TIMELY; RAPP TIP HELPS

Flowers 'Kick' Boots Millers

By BOB BEERE
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Ben Flowers "kicked" his way out of a prolonged pitching slump Friday night. There also was a timely "kick" in the Denver attack, and the combination delivered a solid boot to Minneapolis' American Association playoff hopes.

The reviving Bears belted the Millers 6-3 to make it two straight at Metropolitan stadium, tightened their grip on second place

and left the home club a precarious one game out of fifth going into this afternoon's series finale.

The victory was Flowers' first since he beat St. Paul 3-1 July 5 and only his fifth against 13 defeats in the most frustrating season of a 14-year mound career. He credits former Miller catcher Vern Rapp for his return to form.

"Last week," Flowers recounted, "I was working with Vern in the bullpen. We were trying to figure out what I could do to get

right again, and Vern said I wasn't kicking my left leg high enough when delivering the ball. So I tried kicking higher and my good stuff seemed to come back right away."

"This one sure feels good," he concluded. "It was a mighty long dry spell."

And manager Andy Cohen put in: "It couldn't have come at a better time. But that's the way with this club. The boys have had a lot of hard luck but they've never given up."

The Bears now hope Flowers can stay in the groove because he was a big factor in last year's success, finishing with a string of 11 straight victories. He also won three of his first four this season before going from May 11 until last night with only one more win.

Tall Ben limited the Millers to six hits and was tough down the stretch as his mates came on to beat Dean Stone in the eighth and ninth. And it was local boy John Blanchard and

the valuable Rapp who cooked the Mauchmen's goose.

Blanchard, who has stung the ball for five hits in the two games, lined his 16th home run of the season off the right field foul-pole screen with two on in the third. And Rapp, playing first base in Denver's patchwork scheme, singled home what proved to be the winning run in the eighth.

While the Millers were losing, Wichita and Omaha moved within a game of them. The Braves beat Charleston 5-1 on Ray Ripplemeyer's four-hitter and the Cardinals dunked St. Paul again 9-5. Indianapolis downed Louisville 7-5 in 10 innings.

Thus Charleston still needs a combination of five victories and Denver defeats to clinch the pennant. Minneapolis' fatal



JOHN BLANCHARD lives in Minneapolis but he plays baseball for Denver and Friday night he struck a hard blow against the Millers when he socked his 16th home run of the season with two men on to help beat them at Metropolitan stadium. Here Bear manager Andy Cohen grabs Johnny's hand in hurried congratulations as he rounds third base on his third-inning swat.—Star photo by Paul Siegel.

Big Cars Race Sunday at Fair

Big car racing takes over Sunday afternoon at the Minnesota State fair track where Willie Hunziker took the lead on the 20th lap and won the

Don White, Ernie Derr and Bob Burdick, who placed one, two, three, respectively, in the 50-lap feature Thursday, were disqualified for il-

